

THE GIANT STEPS

- By serving unmet needs for affordable access to complex biologics, India's biosimilar players can replicate the generics industry's success
- The Indian pharmaceutical industry should adopt a unified standard of global excellence, ensuring "highest quality for all markets"
- By leveraging AI, ML and Data Analytics, India can gain an edge in generics and biosimilars, and emerge as a global leader in innovative drug development and personalised medicine

Ensuring quality focus: The Indian pharmaceutical industry should adopt a unified standard of global excellence, ensuring the "highest quality for all markets". This commitment to universal quality will not only strengthen global trust in Indian pharmaceuticals but also reinforce the ethical responsibility to provide safe and effective medicines to everyone. To improve quality standards and compliance, the government has recently notified the revised rules under Schedule M of the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules, prescribing the Good Manufacturing Practices for pharmaceutical products and introducing a stronger quality system for all drug products.

Encouraging digital transformation: Artificial Intelligence (AI), Machine Learning (ML) and Data Analytics are revolutionising drug discovery, development, manufacturing and distribution. By leveraging these technologies, India can not only gain an edge in generics and biosimilars but also emerge as a global leader in innovative drug development and personalised medicine. To encourage corporate investment in Industry 4.0 tools, the government should consider incentives such as weighted deductions on digital transformation spending or GST exemptions.

Boosting infrastructure development: A robust infrastructure is vital for a competitive pharmaceutical industry. Policy tools like the Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme, offering fiscal incentives for production capacity and technology upgrades, can help transform India into a global bio-manufacturing hub. The PLI scheme for medical devices is already narrowing the export-import gap.

Strategic shift: While the journey is challenging, the Indian pharmaceutical industry has the potential to become a global leader in high-value pharmaceutical exports with the right strategies and policies. By embracing value-addition over volume, the industry can achieve its ambitious target of $130 billion (Rs 10.9 lakh crore) by 2030, nearly tripling from the current $50 billion (Rs 4.2 lakh crore). This strategic shift will not only enhance India's global standing but also make a significant contribution to global healthcare. ■

The author is Executive Chairperson, Biocon and Biocon Biologics

Illustration by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**